A LOCAL MCP SERVER FOR CLAUDE + CODEX

Make your Calibre library talk to your AI.

Search it. Question it.
Build skills from what you read.



Your books



mcp-calibre

Claude

Codex

LOCAL LIBRARY / READ-ONLY ACCESS / v5.4.1

WHAT IT IS

A local MCP server. A bridge to your books.

MCP = Model Context Protocol: tools your AI can call.

ON YOUR COMPUTER



READ ONLY

Text · metadata · figures

Calibre

Your existing library

mcp-calibre

Search cache

Claude / Codex / other MCP clients

Search the books. Read sources. Build useful outputs.

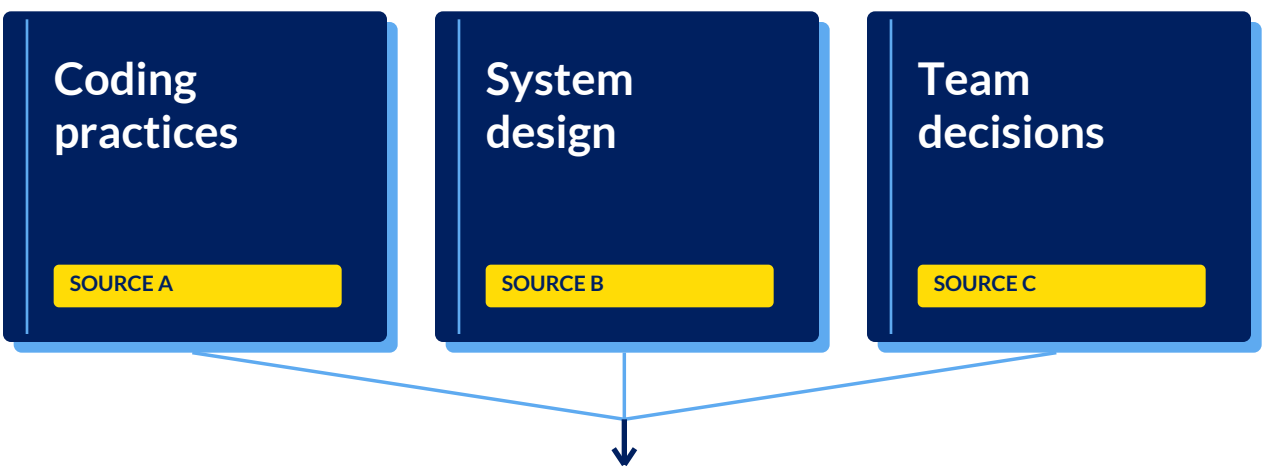
The library stays local. Retrieved content goes to your AI client and follows its data settings.

START WITH A REAL TASK

Ask a question. Find the books behind it.

TRY THIS PROMPT

Which of my books explain agent reliability? Compare where they agree and disagree.



ONE SOURCE-AWARE COMPARISON

Shared ideas / disagreements / chapter references

Full-text + optional semantic search. Fictional source cards.

MAKE KNOWLEDGE REUSABLE

One book.
A method you can reuse.

TRY THIS PROMPT

Use calibre-distill on [book]. Build a decision guide for my engineering team.



SKILL.md

- When to use it
- Decision rules
- Checklist
- Sources

A reusable guide in the assistant's own words.

Companion skill: calibre-distill. Review and install the output.

TWO BOOKS. ONE DECISION.

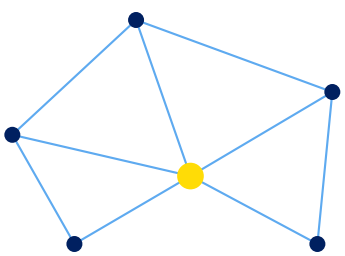
Let two books debate your next move.

TRY THIS PROMPT

Build an agent from each of these two books. Have them debate our migration plan.

Book A

APPROACH A



Book B

APPROACH B

Example focus

Smallest useful test?

Example focus

Failure to prevent?

Compare trade-offs. Ask for chapter evidence.

calibre-book-agent; you arrange the exchange. Illustrative perspectives.

DO THE IDEAS HOLD UP?

Put a book to the evidence test.

TRY THIS PROMPT

Use calibre-book-redteam on [book]. Find the strongest counter-evidence in my library.

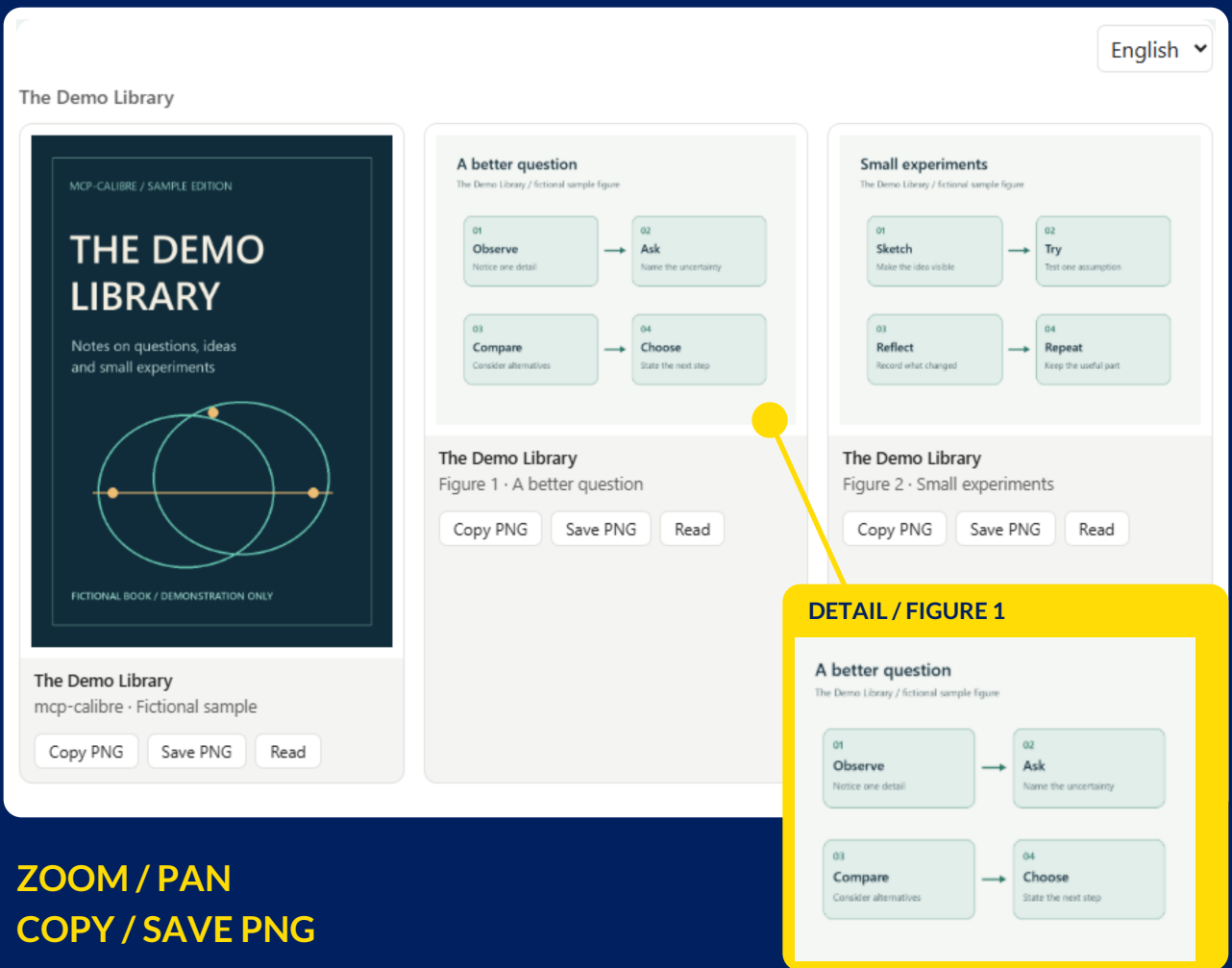
THE RESULT: A CLAIM-BY-CLAIM REPORT

Supported	Sources point the same way.
Qualified	The conditions matter.
Contested	Relevant sources disagree.

Illustrative report structure. A real check can also find contradictions.

LOOK AT WHAT THE BOOK SHOWS

Open the diagram. Inspect the detail.

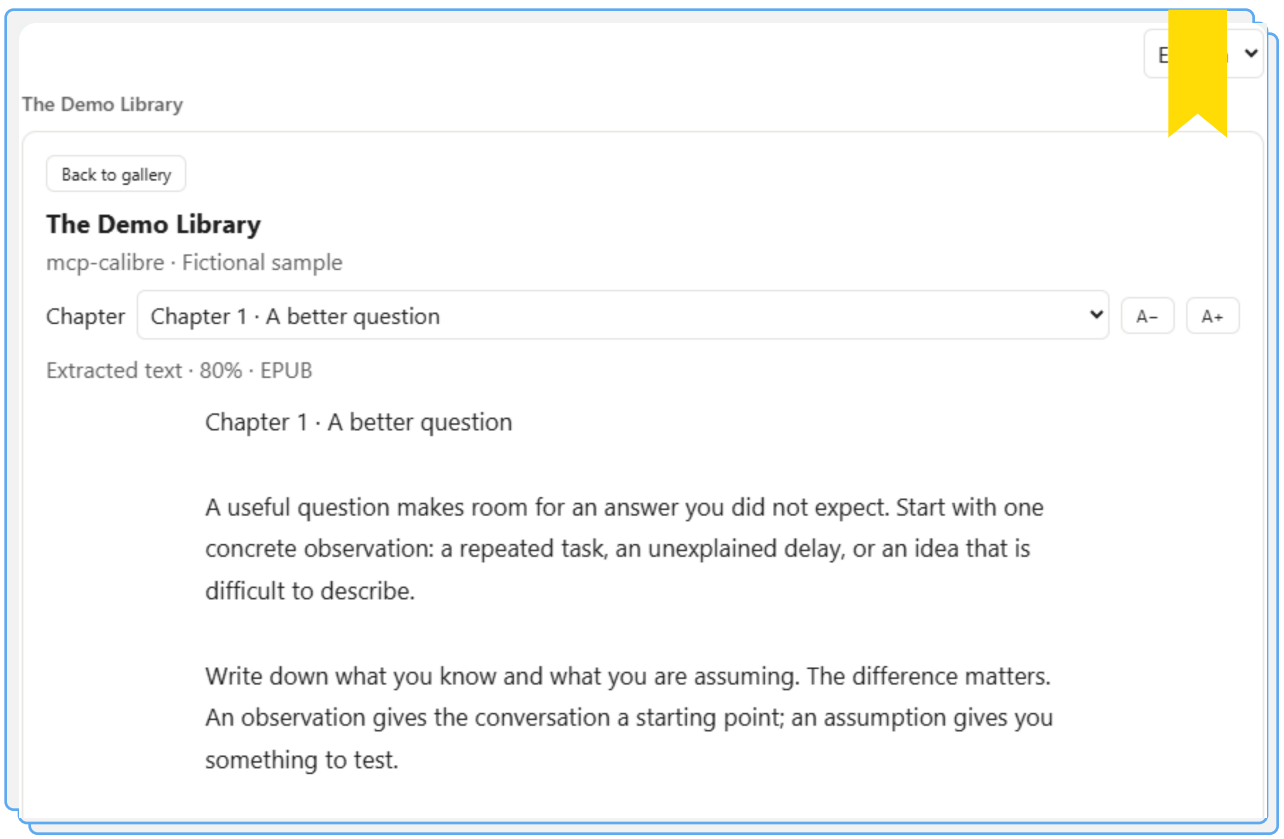


ZOOM / PAN
COPY / SAVE PNG

Actual UI. Simulated host, fictional book. MCP Apps required.

YOUR TURN TO READ

Press Read.
Stay in the conversation.



CHAPTERS | TEXT SIZE | CONTINUE

Extracted text, not original layout. MCP Apps required.

FROM INSTALL TO FIRST QUESTION

Connect it. Ask. Then build.

01

Install the server

Clone or unzip the repo. On Windows, run setup-wizard.bat and select your Calibre library.

02

Connect Claude or Codex

Use the client-specific MCP setup in the docs.
Verify it: “List my Calibre libraries.”

03

Try a task, then add a skill

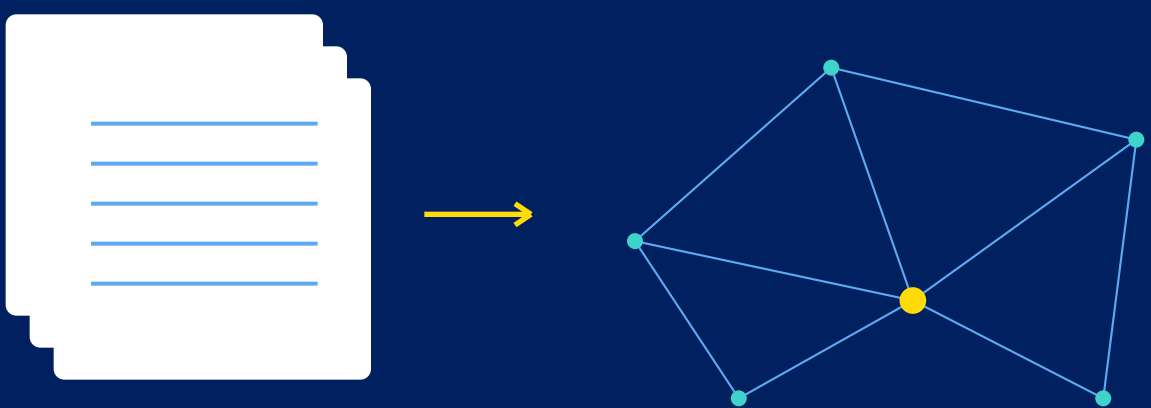
Search a topic and inspect the source chapter.
Install a companion skill for the advanced workflows.

Python 3.10+ + Calibre. macOS/Linux: manual setup.

AI INSIDE THE SEARCH LAYER

Find the meaning. Beyond the exact words.

A local embedding model maps book passages and your question into the same vector space.



PASSAGES

SEMANTIC NEIGHBOURS

Multilingual MiniLM + fastembed

ONNX on CPU / downloaded once / runs locally

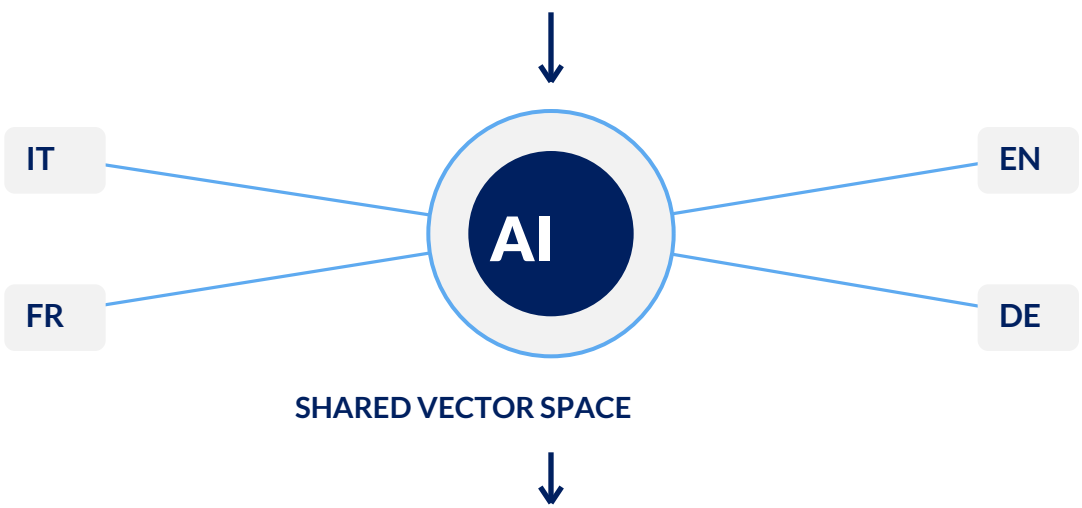
Optional semantic index. The model retrieves; Claude/Codex answers.

ASK IN YOUR LANGUAGE

An Italian question. An English passage.

YOUR QUESTION / ITALIAN

Come rendere affidabili gli agenti?



RELEVANT PASSAGES / ENGLISH

Agent reliability, with source references.

Illustrative query. Semantic matching across languages; exact-word search still needs the language of the text.

YOUR LIBRARY STAYS INTACT

Build the search layer. Keep the originals.



CALIBRE LIBRARY

Books + original databases

READ-ONLY ACCESS

Index separately

index.db

Full-text

Words + extracted text

embeddings.db

Semantic

Passages + vectors

figures.db

Figures

Captions + optional vectors

One sidecar folder per library.

Indexes can be rebuilt. Calibre books and databases stay unchanged.

UNLOCK SCANNED PDFS

A scanned page. Searchable knowledge.

SCANNED PDF



EXTRACTED TEXT

Recognise the words.

Index the text.

Find the passage.

Read the source.

Tesseract + PyMuPDF

Run the OCR batch, then search and read.

Optional. Italian + English by default; more language packs available.
Scan quality affects recognition. Your original PDF is preserved.



mcp-calibre

Local MCP server · v5.4.1

From books you own to ideas you can use.

31 assistant tools. Four companion skills.
Read-only access to your Calibre library.

Get the code. Connect your library.

github.com/jumpifequal/mcp-calibre

README / SETUP GUIDES / EXAMPLES

Your AI client receives the content it retrieves.